

CHAPTER EIGHT

HIRING THE RIGHT AGENT

Unlike finding the right lender, whose quality is basically dependent on the numbers they offer, finding the right real estate agent is much less straightforward. An agent makes money by earning a commission of about 2.5 to 3 percent of the total value of the property bought or sold, which is usually included in the *seller's* closing costs—meaning that you're not shopping for an agent by price. Instead, you're looking for an agent who will contribute positively to your home-buying experience with great advice, suggestions, and support.

To be honest, we've ruined you with this book. You're no longer the ideal client. (You've seen too much.) To a typical real estate agent, a dream client looks like this:

- A high-income individual with a great credit score who's in the market for a luxury, high-end property
- An emotionally driven decision maker who's seeking their perfect dream home and will fall in love with one of the first properties they visit
- Someone who's dismayed by what seems to be a lack of housing inventory on the market and will settle for a less-than-ideal purchase price
- Someone with a tight, deadline-driven purchase timeline

This kind of home buyer basically guarantees a large, quick paycheck. Those who are considered “top” agents are often capable of finding and serving the largest number of these easy home buyers—it's simply good business that means more money in less time for the agent.

You, however, are smarter than the average home buyer. To an agent, you will look like this:

- You have dependable income and great credit, but you're looking for a property well within your means.